

Seagate 2.5 GB USB 2.0 Pocket Hard Drive

This external hard drive from Seagate is about as big as a Marie biscuit and 1.5 inches thick, but packs in a cool 2.5 GB of space. It connects to a system via the USB 2.0 interface. You can write-protect and password-protect the drive.

SiSoft Sandra reported read and write speeds of 6 MBps and 5 MBps respectively. The average access time was 17 ms. The compact drive does seem like a handy tool for

photographers and anyone else who needs to transport large amounts of data. However, at Rs 10,000, it is fairly overpriced.



Company **Fortune Marketing Pvt. Ltd.**
Price **Rs 10,000 for 2.5 GB; Rs 15,000 for 5 GB**
Phone **26472491** Mobile **9810155208**
Web site **www.seagate.com**

Rating

MSI Mega View 561 Portable Media Player

Way Too Expensive

This sleek device is MSI's answer to the iPods and Gminis of today. It packs in a respectable 20 GB of disk space and a 3.5-inch LCD screen that has surprisingly good clarity.

The device supports viewing and playback of the DivX 3.11/4/5, MPEG4, WMV, MP3, WAV, WMA9, JPEG, GIF, TIFF, and BMP formats. It supports a maximum of 30 fps in video and 320 Kbps audio—really good quality DivX.

The device records voice as well, and the mic is really sensitive. It even has an inbuilt FM tuner, programmable for eight stations.

Using the bundled AV cables, the MSI Mega View can record to and play back from a TV.

The device does not have the ability to create playlists. The bundled earphones are good, but since they are not padded, your ears cannot take more than an hour of continuous listening. Overall, great features, a few bugs, and way too expensive!



Company **Cyberstar Infocom Limited**
Price **Rs 28,500**
Phone **0-9323809599**
E-mail **info@cyberstarindia.com**
Web site **www.msi.com.tw**

Rating

New & Notable

One PC EX

This device is a PC-sharing solution. Though a little expensive, it can save you money if you need another system for general office work.

It looks like a sleek blue wireless hub with a blue backlit neon power button. There are connectors for the keyboard, monitor, mouse, LAN and speakers. The existing PC connects to this device using a crossover LAN cable.

To test for performance, we used a Pentium 4 3.2 GHz processor with 1 GB of RAM, but still couldn't play two movies simultaneously on the host and virtual PCs. However, it does everything else commendably well, such as playing a movie on one computer and music on the other. The Rs 10,000 price tag is a little steep though, as today, computers for office use cost only about Rs 15,000. It's up to you to decide whether the Rs 5,000 difference is worth it or not!



Company **Adline Systems**
Price **Rs 10,000**
Phone **011-25720911 / 25720441**
E-mail **adline@bol.net.in**
Web site **www.adlinesystems.com**

Rating

Kodak LS755

A Great Looker, But...

This five-megapixel, 3x optical zoom camera fits perfectly in your hand, and is nice and light. It has tiny, interesting-looking lights on the top, which display capture modes such as Auto and Movie. The 2.5-inch LCD screen crisply displays the images in focus, along with the various options such as white balance.

Strangely, the menu button is on the top, and the ON/OFF button and the hard-to-handle menu navigation joystick are placed beside the LCD screen. Selecting and navigating through the menu is difficult. The lack of an optical viewfinder means that you are forced to drain your batteries by using the LCD all the time. The Auto setting works fine, but others, such as Night Mode, end up producing images with blue tinges.

Even in broad daylight, images appear dark, and the flash goes off. Detail and textures in the captured images are superb, though.

Indoor shots come out better, especially close-ups in Macro Mode; but outdoors, with an overcast sky, the images are very dark. In order to connect this camera to a PC you need to carry around the USB connector-cum-power docking station everywhere, as it doesn't connect directly. Also, there's only 16 MB of internal memory. Overall, a great looking camera, but with a lot of drawbacks.



Company **Neoteric Informatique**
Price **Rs 23,900**
Phone **022-39828600**
E-mail **sales@neoteric-info.com**
Web site **www.kodak.com**

Rating